

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – November 2024

Period analysed	March – November 2024
Months carrying comments	Mar 2024 – Nov 2024
Comments collected	1,236
Of which substantive	692 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	70 (10.1% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2024. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

1,236 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **692** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **70 (10.1%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

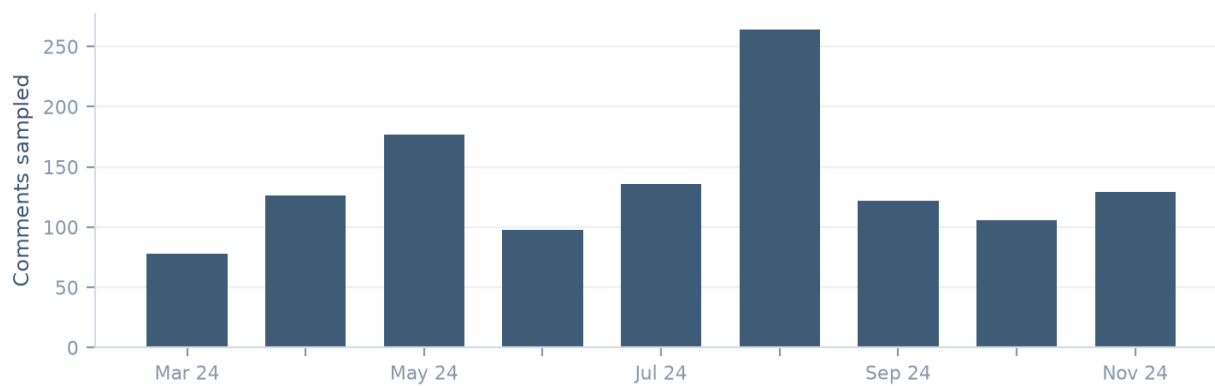
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

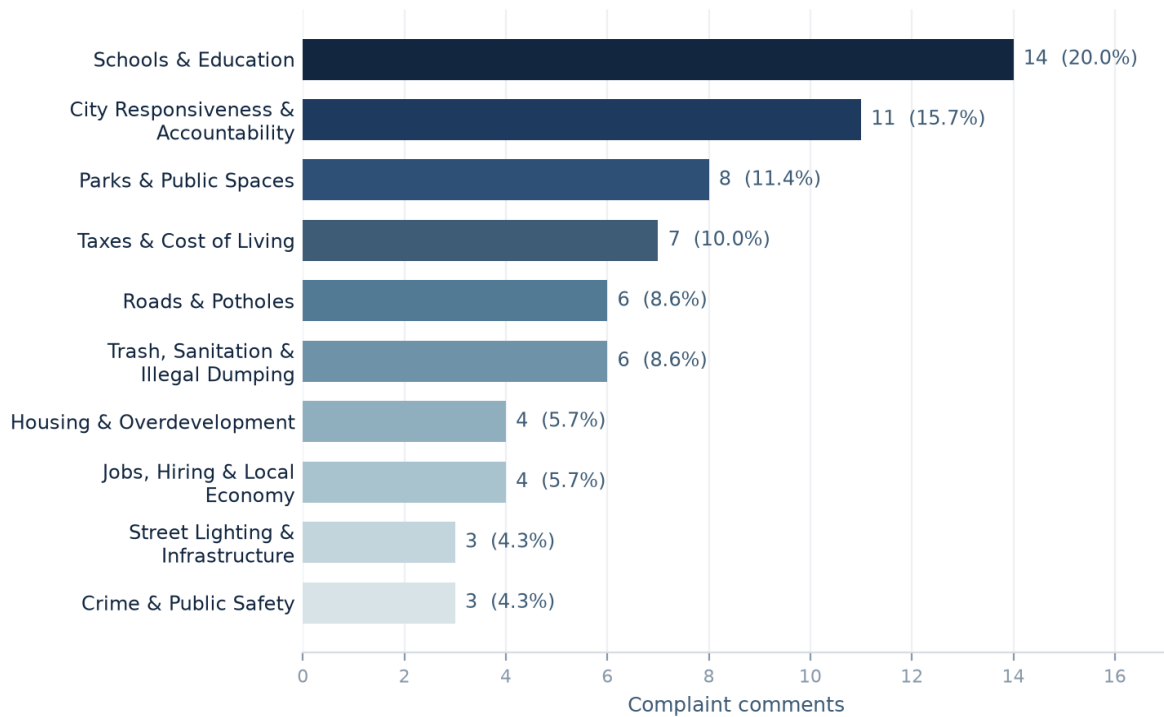
- Coverage for this window: 165 Facebook posts and 332 Instagram posts were sampled. Facebook's public feed is paged in date-bounded slices, so this is a sample of the period rather than every post the city published in it.
- The city's pages drew far less engagement in this period than they do now - many posts carry no comments at all - so the complaint counts here are much smaller than in recent years. Compare shares between periods rather than raw counts.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts inside the window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it in this window. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

Schools & Education is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 20.0% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Schools & Education, City Responsiveness & Accountability, Parks & Public Spaces — together make up 47% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

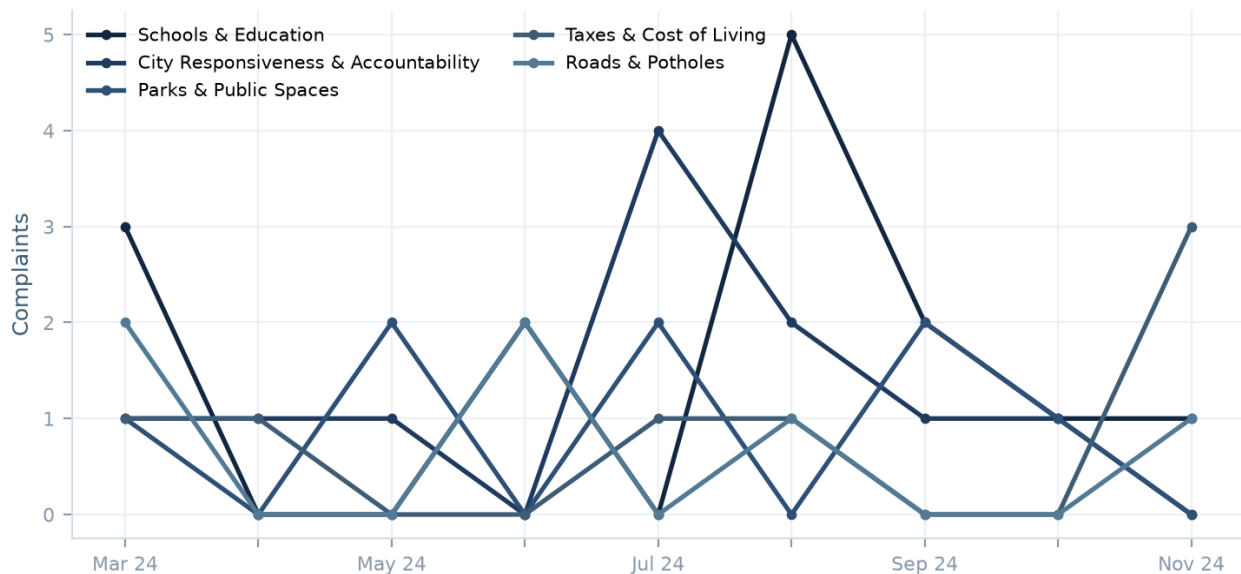


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Schools & Education	14	20.0%	2.1
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	11	15.7%	0.5
3	Parks & Public Spaces	8	11.4%	1.0
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	7	10.0%	1.3
5	Roads & Potholes	6	8.6%	2.3
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	6	8.6%	3.3
7	Housing & Overdevelopment	4	5.7%	4.8
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	4	5.7%	0.5
9	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	3	4.3%	1.3
10	Crime & Public Safety	3	4.3%	1.7

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Schools & Education

14 complaints · 20.0% of all complaints · Instagram 11 · Facebook 3



"Oh man what would our children's education do without a bunch of pedophiles guiding them while in school. How about paying teachers better and upping security. You people in office are not only a joke but you play dangerous games"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week, @mayormikespano swore in the incredible members of the Mayor's LGBTQ+ Advisory ..."

"Meanwhile the education and safety of student's etc in all of the Yonkers school system SUCKS ■■■■■!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Big news! ■ A cool investment in our children's future: The City of Yonkers and Yonkers P..."

"Now put that money back in to the awful school system!!! Pay the teachers and give CSEA fair pay!!!!!! N by CSEA I mean the aids n the people WHO WORK IN THE SCHOOLS NOT central office"

Instagram · 2024 · 14 likes · on: "With a total of 18,132 violations recorded since the Yonkers Safe Stop program's launch, w..."

"Improve the kids quality of EDUCATION AND SCHOOL LUNCHES @—"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "@mayormikespano's 2024 State of the City: Public Safety ■■■ Ensuring Safety, Building Tru..."

2

City Responsiveness & Accountability

11 complaints · 15.7% of all complaints · Instagram 8 · Facebook 3



"Is @— aware the kind of corrupt waterhead you are @—?"

Instagram · 2024 · 2 likes · on: "Thank you @guyfieri for visiting @cityofyonkers and shouting out our first responders who ..."

"It was or still is called the CITY OF THE PRECIOUS LIVING or something like that. It has changed a lot, I miss the old way of life in those days."

Facebook · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Taking you back to the early 1930s in Downtown Yonkers! ■■..."

"@— every city, town govt is like this. They're all corrupt"

Instagram · 2024 · on: "Hey Yonkers! Did you know...in August 2021, Fatima Taylor became the first African America..."

"All this is a photo prop. Mayor need to fix the housing crisis in Yonkers as well as the terrible special education department!"

Facebook · 2024 · 2 likes · on: "Catch a glimpse of Mayor Spano sharing the wonder of books with young Ryan from Yonkers Pu..."

3

Parks & Public Spaces

8 complaints · 11.4% of all complaints · Instagram 6 · Facebook 2



"Looks really nice! May I please implore for upgrades to the WELTY PARK Playground? I think it's been about 20 years."

Facebook · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "We're thrilled to unveil the new Clemens Park on Leighton Ave! ■ The Yonkers Parks Depart..."

"Can we please fix Pelton Park on McLean it's crazy how they can do the soccer field and all that other stuff but can't fix the basketball court"

Instagram · 2024 · 2 likes · on: "Celebrating #NationalParksandRecreationMonth with a look at our beloved H. Boo Wilson Park..."

"Sadly nothing kids friendly or playground for kids. America is all about business they don't care about kids. Mean while all most every where in Europe the dining location has a playground for kids!!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Cantina, a Westchester favorite, has popped open its second location in Ridge Hill. On the..."

"We need more basketball courts with glass backboards"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Celebrating #NationalParksandRecreationMonth with a look at our beloved H. Boo Wilson Park..."

4

Taxes & Cost of Living

7 complaints · 10.0% of all complaints · Instagram 7



"Get ready for a smooth ride? Lmao there's not a smooth road in Yonkers and hasn't been for years. I wonder where our tax money is really going"

Instagram · 2024 · 2 likes · on: "Yonkers, get ready for a smooth ride! ■ Exciting news as Governor Kathy Hochul announced ..."

"Yonkers public maintenance is a total joke. You need to do better we the taxes we pay here."

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Welcome to the new and improved Stilwell Park! ■ Head over to McLean Ave. and experience ..."

"Ummm this is why there is taxes. How about use city funds to feed the families ?"

Instagram · 2024 · on: "Due to gas leaks, the gas at Palisade Towers has unfortunately been shut down until furthe..."

"The renovation is a joke, it took way to long for it to be completed and yet somehow it's still incomplete. The volume of kids and families that come here to have waited as long as we did for this "upgrade" is a slap in our faces. Especially now that we know that you all cheapened out and didn't use the allotted budget given. DO BETTER"

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Welcome to the new and improved Stilwell Park! ■ Head over to McLean Ave. and experience ..."

5

Roads & Potholes

6 complaints · 8.6% of all complaints · Instagram 5 · Facebook 1

*"Hope there is an update when some of these roads are getting paved???"*

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Introducing Yonkers-Tron – our sleek new LED display sign on the Government Center Garage ..."

"Show us the data for potholes in Yonkers. Feels like that was overlooked for years."

Instagram · 2024 · 7 likes · on: "@mayormikespano's 2024 State of the City: Public Safety ■■■ Ensuring Safety, Building Tru..."

"That's great, now can you please fix the big pothole that is called Saw Mill River Rd? By Oakland Cemetery. Feel like my engine is going to fall out every time I drive on that road. For this you get a big fat ZERO"

Facebook · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "For the 10th consecutive year, Yonkers has scored a perfect 100 on the Municipal Equality ..."

"Fix the nasty potholes we have all over the city"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Over on Oak Street, checking on our first responders. Thank you for your service and answe..."

6

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

6 complaints · 8.6% of all complaints · Instagram 5 · Facebook 1

*"All great accomplishments and I would love to be proud of my city. Please do something about the litter. The streets are a garbage dump. Please find a way to enforce litter laws. It's embarrassing to all of us who live here."*

Instagram · 2024 · 2 likes · on: "@mayormikespano's 2024 State of the City: Public Safety ■■■ Ensuring Safety, Building Tru..."

"Would never rat on a hard working landscaper. Go after the loud cars and illegal mopeds."

Facebook · 2024 · 13 likes · on: "Yonkers Gas-Powered Leaf Blower Ban is in full effect from June 1 to Sept 30 annually. Sav..."

"Child predator flag right there. No other flag should be flying there only the American flag ■■■. No one cares what you're doing in your rooms take that garbage down."

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Raising the LGBTQIA+ flag high at Yonkers City Hall! ■■■■ Tomorrow, our streets flood wit..."

"Mayor Flintstone and the ghetto trash Tasha Diaz. ■"

Instagram · 2024 · on: "It's an annual tradition at Stew Leonard's (Yonkers) teaming up with our Yonkers Police De..."

7

Housing & Overdevelopment

4 complaints · 5.7% of all complaints · Instagram 3 · Facebook 1

*"Why does he have to ask for school funding with all these building projects going up??? Cause our tax dollars are going into their pockets that's why!! Ridiculous to ask for funds should be getting funds from these billionaires putting up these high rises from the developers not tax payers!!! More buildings more traffic more crime more traffic!! But more money in their pockets ■"*

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week's Your Yonkers Now highlights the diversity of Yonkers plus more on the Mayor's ..."

"Who can afford that? Luxury in the ghetto is crazy."

Instagram · 2024 · 14 likes · on: "Discover your next home at 70 Pier Street! ■ Immerse yourself in luxury with upscale, tra..."

"Isn't that a city owned municipal housing building ? If the gas is off then the city if yonkers should have stepped up a d provided whatever was needed . Why did they go out begging businesses to provide and then filming it so they can look good. These political stunts are getting ridiculous"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Look what our community can do! Yesterday, I issued a call to action -- asking local busin..."

8

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

4 complaints · 5.7% of all complaints · Instagram 4



"This renovation is a complete joke! The equipment is small and not accessible for kids with disabilities. There are fences missing, holes in the ground, uneven pavement, the new padding is missing in a few areas making it dangerous for anyone who is running/walking around. Should've just left the park alone if you were going to do a half-assed job."

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Welcome to the new and improved Stilwell Park! ■ Head over to McLean Ave. and experience ..."

"Great job! When will Schultz park open?? Closed for a very long time!!!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Stefanik Park just got a major upgrade! Check out the brand new basketball court, enhanced..."

9

Street Lighting & Infrastructure

3 complaints · 4.3% of all complaints · Instagram 2 · Facebook 1



"kudos for the safety enhancement ... but maybe, as a kind suggestion, signs should be added to the poles saying that all vehicles must stop when lights are flashing ?"

Facebook · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "Yonkers leads the way as the first city in Westchester to install LaneLight In-Road Warnin..."

"Such a loss. ■. I think of him and that terrible day every time I cross that bridge."

Instagram · 2024 · on: "A heartfelt salute to the legacy of Yonkers Police Detective Sergeant Frank Gualdino ■ To..."

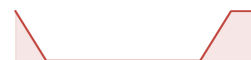
"I remember staying at 2 Schroeder on the 5th floor with shopping bags walking up the stairs because elevators always out of service and pissy..... Fix them elevators too!!!"

Instagram · 2024 · on: "Look what our community can do! Yesterday, I issued a call to action -- asking local busin..."

10

Crime & Public Safety

3 complaints · 4.3% of all complaints · Instagram 2 · Facebook 1



"Crime rate down but there were more stabbings and shoot outs in my old neighborhood to the point where the mayor had to do a conference on my old block. And that in the LAST TWO YEARS"

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "@mayormikespano's 2024 State of the City: Public Safety ■■■ Ensuring Safety, Building Tru..."

"Good afternoon I have lived in Yonkers for the past 37 years and it has changed a lot get rid of all the crime and we should be fine I used to work down near the Yonkers museum, Thomas McVicar roofing."

Facebook · 2024 · on: "Taking you back to the early 1930s in Downtown Yonkers! ■■..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Schools & Education	14	18	20.0%
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	11	11	15.7%
3	Parks & Public Spaces	8	8	11.4%
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	7	9	10.0%
5	Roads & Potholes	6	6	8.6%
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	6	6	8.6%
7	Housing & Overdevelopment	4	4	5.7%
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	4	4	5.7%
9	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	3	3	4.3%
10	Crime & Public Safety	3	4	4.3%
11	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	2	2	2.9%
12	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	1	1	1.4%
13	Parking	1	1	1.4%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.